

Power of Interest
Expense Control Policy & Expense claim form

Version: 0.2

Approved by: Vivian Okolie

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Review date: July 2027

1. Purpose and Scope

Power of Interest (POI) UK relies heavily on the dedication of university student coaches, tournament adjudicators, and directors. We believe that volunteering should not leave anyone out of pocket. The purpose of this policy is to ensure that volunteers and staff are fairly reimbursed for legitimate expenses incurred while delivering our debate programmes, while protecting charity funds from misuse. This policy applies to all registered volunteers, student coaches, invited tournament judges, and directors of POI UK.

2. Core Principles

- **Reimbursement Only:** POI UK only reimburses actual, necessary costs incurred wholly for charity business. We do not pay flat-rate volunteer allowances.
- **Pre-Authorization:** Any expense projected to exceed **£50** must be approved in writing by the Treasurer *before* the purchase is made.
- **Proof of Purchase:** Every single expense claim **must** be backed up by a valid itemised receipt or VAT invoice. Credit card slips or bank statements alone are not acceptable proof.
- **Submission Deadline:** All expense claims must be submitted within **30 days** of the cost being incurred. Late claims may be rejected.

3. Permissible Travel Expenses

Volunteers are expected to use the most cost-effective and environmentally friendly mode of transport reasonable for their journey.

- **Public Transport (Trains and Buses):**
 - Standard or Standard Class tickets only. First-class travel will not be reimbursed under any circumstances.

- o Tickets should be booked as far in advance as possible to secure "advance" discounts.
 - o TfL Oyster/Contactless users must download and submit a journey history statement from the TfL website showing the specific route and fare.
- **Motoring (Personal Car/Motorbike):**
 - o Reimbursement is calculated using standard UK HM Revenue & Customs (HMRC) approved mileage rates. These rates cover fuel, wear and tear, and insurance.
 - o **Car Mileage Rate:** 45p per mile for the first 10,000 miles in a financial year.
 - o **Motorbike Mileage Rate:** 24p per mile.
 - o Drivers must confirm they hold valid business use insurance when submitting a claim.
- **Taxis:** Taxis will only be reimbursed under exceptional circumstances (e.g., transporting heavy tournament trophies/equipment, no public transport options available, or for personal safety late at night). Prior approval from a director is required.

4. Subsistence (Food and Drink)

When volunteering at an all-day POI UK event or travelling long distances, volunteers can claim back the cost of refreshments up to the following maximum caps:

- **Breakfast (If leaving home before 7:00 AM):** Up to £5.00
- **Lunch (If volunteering for more than 5 consecutive hours):** Up to £7.50
- **Dinner (If working past 8:00 PM due to tournament schedule):** Up to £15.00 [23]

Note: POI UK will not reimburse the purchase of alcohol under any circumstances.

5. Tournament and Operational Supplies

If a volunteer needs to purchase operational materials for a debate tournament (e.g., printing ballots, buying venue stationery, or purchasing winner medals):

- They must obtain email authorization from the Treasurer or Tournament Convenor before purchasing.
- Whenever possible, items should be purchased using the central POI UK charity account rather than personal funds.

6. Non-Reimbursable Costs

The following are examples of items that POI UK will **not** pay for:

- Fines for parking, speeding, or public transport fare evasion.

- Childcare costs or pet care costs while volunteering.
- Lost property or personal items damaged while on charity business.
- Subscriptions or software licenses not explicitly ordered by the Board.

POWER OF INTEREST (POI) UK

Appendix A: POI UK Expense Claim Form

1. CLAIMANT INFORMATION	
Full Name:	
Role at POI UK:	
Email Address:	[Name@university.ac.uk]
Bank Name & Account No:	

2. ITEMISED EXPENSES [24]		
Date	Description of Expense (Include Tournament/School Name)	Amount (£)
DD/MM/YYYY	<i>e.g., Return train ticket from Birmingham to London for Winter Cup</i>	£24.50
DD/MM/YYYY	<i>e.g., Lunch subsistence (5+ hours volunteering at school workshop)</i>	£6.20
DD/MM/YYYY	<i>e.g., Mileage: 40 miles @ 45p/mile (Driving debate equipment to venue)</i>	£18.00
	TOTAL CLAIM AMOUNT:	£48.70

3. DECLARATION & AUTHORIZATION

Claimant Declaration: I certify that the expenses detailed above were actually and necessarily incurred on behalf of POI UK, that receipts are attached, and that my vehicle is fully insured for business use (if claiming mileage).

Claimant Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Internal Approval (Treasurer/Director Use Only):

Approved Amount: £ _____

Approved By: _____ Signature: _____ Date:
